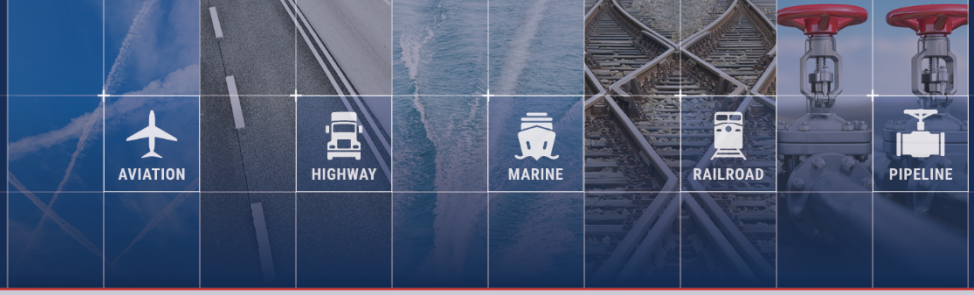

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Loganville, Georgia	**Accident Number:**	ERA25LA085
Date & Time:	December 25, 2024, 17:00 Local	**Registration:**	N6665K
Aircraft:	Aeronca 15AC	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Collision during takeoff/land	**Injuries:**	1 Serious
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The airline transport pilot was attempting to land when he lost his reference to the runway due to sun glare and attempted to go around. The airplane impacted trees, which resulted in both wings separating from the airplane. The pilot said there were no mechanical malfunctions or failures that contributed to the accident and that the accident could have been prevented if he had tried to go around sooner.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The pilot's failure to maintain clearance of trees during an attempted go-around in sun glare.

Findings

Personnel issues	Monitoring environment - Pilot
Environmental issues	Glare - Effect on personnel
Aircraft	Altitude - Not attained/maintained

Factual Information

History of Flight

Approach-VFR go-around	Collision during takeoff/land (Defining event)

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Airline transport	**Age:**	70,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine land; Single-engine sea; Multi-engine land; Multi-engine sea	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Lap only
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3 Without waivers/limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	September 24, 2024
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	April 22, 2024
Flight Time:	3164 hours (Total, all aircraft), 110 hours (Total, this make and model), 2962 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 11.3 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 3 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft), 0 hours (Last 24 hours, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Aeronca	**Registration:**	N6665K
Model/Series:	15AC	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1950	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	15AC-533
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	July 2, 2024 Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2050 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	3298 Hrs as of last inspection	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Continental
ELT:	C91A installed, activated, did not aid in locating accident	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-300-A
Registered Owner:	On file	**Rated Power:**	145 Horsepower
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KD73,867 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	58 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	15:55 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	324°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	/	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.23 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	14°C / 0°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Loganville, GA	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Loganville, GA	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:		**Type of Airspace:**	Class G

Airport Information

Airport:	SPRING VALLEY FARM 6GA4	**Runway Surface Type:**	Grass/turf
Airport Elevation:	920 ft msl	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	06/24	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	3000 ft / 100 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Full stop

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 Serious	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:		**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 Serious	**Latitude, Longitude:**	33.797055,-83.851292(est)

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Read, Leah
Additional Participating Persons:	Bradley Harrell; FAA/FSDO; Atlanta, GA
Original Publish Date:	April 22, 2025
Last Revision Date:	June 10, 2025
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199489

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.